

Figure 6.3.1 illustrates the percentage distribution of the population with at least one non-communicable disease by age group.

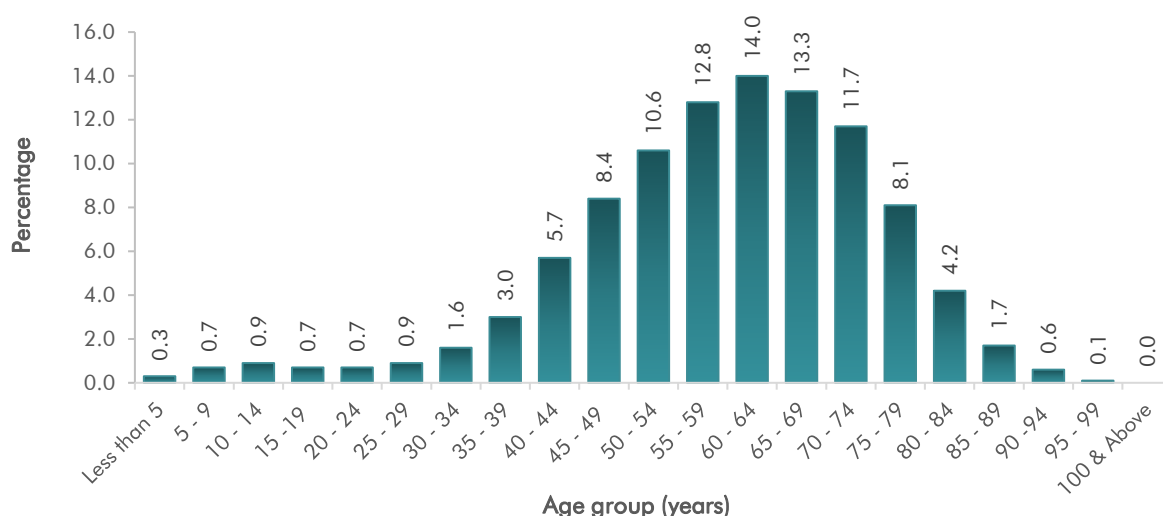


Figure 6.3.1 : Percentage Distribution of the Population with at least One Non-Communicable Disease by Age Group, 2024

According to the data in Table 6.3.3, high blood pressure, diabetes, and high cholesterol report the highest prevalence rates within the total population, respectively. Among these, high blood pressure is the most widely prevalent. One in every ten persons in the total population suffers from high blood pressure. The prevalence rates for diabetes and high cholesterol in the total population are 8.5 percent and 8.2 percent, respectively. Heart disease and asthma were reported by 2.5 percent and 1.8 percent of the total population, respectively. Other medical conditions, namely kidney disease, stroke, cancer, epilepsy, and thalassemia, were reported at rates of less than 1 percentage.

Table 6.3.3 : Number of Individuals Living with Non-Communicable Diseases and Prevalence Rates, 2024

Non-Communicable Disease (NCD)	Number	Prevalence Rate
High Blood Pressure	2,200,179	10.1
Diabetes	1,850,857	8.5
High Cholesterol	1,795,939	8.2
Heart Disease	534,480	2.5
Asthma	401,406	1.8
Kidney Disease	171,348	0.8
Stroke/Paralysis	128,396	0.6
Cancer	85,787	0.4
Epilepsy	65,008	0.3
Thalassemia	18,645	0.1

Prevalence Rates of Non-Communicable Diseases by District

The prevalence rates of non-communicable diseases (NCDs) by district are presented in Table 6.3.4. Accordingly, high blood pressure reports the highest prevalence rate in almost every district. A notable finding in the district-level analysis is that the diabetes and high blood pressure prevalence rates in Colombo, Gampaha, and Jaffna districts are over 10 percent. Among the districts, Kegalle (11.7%), Kandy (11.6%), and Matale (11.3%) report the highest prevalence rates for high blood pressure. The highest prevalence rates for diabetes were reported in Colombo (10.7%), Gampaha (10.5%), and Jaffna (10.4%) districts. Meanwhile, the highest prevalence rates for high cholesterol were reported in the Jaffna (9.9%), Gampaha (9.6%), and Matara (9.6%) districts.